FIELD PLAYBOOK

Modern Pharmaceutical Sales Strategies

Reverse negotiation · financial modelling · behavioural science

Six strategies · six institutional deliverables



OVERVIEW

PSYCHOLOGY FINANCE SIMULATION

Six strategies, one shift: from pitching to proving

1

FBI Negotiation

Lead the client to a “safe no”, then let calibrated questions do the work.

PSYCHOLOGY

2

Pharmonomics

Talk shelf return and cash flow with the pharmacist, not price.

FINANCE

3

Behavioural Nudge Matrix

Arrange the choice so the right option feels natural and low-risk.

PSYCHOLOGY

4

Business War Games

Rehearse sudden market shocks in real time, under pressure.

SIMULATION

5

Red Teaming

Attack your own product before a competitor does.

SIMULATION

6

AI Persona Simulator

Practise on a virtual physician and get scored on five dimensions.

SIMULATION

Each strategy ends in an **institutional deliverable**, a tool the whole team keeps using after the training.

STRATEGY 1 · PSYCHOLOGY

FBI negotiation: from persuasion to reverse negotiation

STEP 1

Accusation audit

Voice their objections first

STEP 2

A “safe no”

The client feels in control

STEP 3

Calibrated questions

Open “how” questions invite collaboration

OUTCOME

They solve it

The client works out the answer themselves

ACCUSATION AUDIT · OPENING LINE

“Doctor, you probably think I’m here to repeat the same scientific pitch you hear every day, and that our product is priced higher without justification.”

- Impact: raising the objection first neutralises their defensive posture.

CLOSED QUESTION · REMOVED

~~“Will you prescribe our product?”~~

CALIBRATED · OPEN “HOW” QUESTIONS

“How can I support you in cases that don’t respond to first-line treatment?”

“How can we overcome the price barrier for the patient without affecting treatment quality?”

Deliverable: **FBI Negotiation Playbook**, covering the top 10 market objections, each paired with calibrated questions

STRATEGY 2 · FINANCE

Pharmonomics: speak the pharmacy's financial language

SHELF RETURN, NOT SIMPLE MARGIN

$$\text{GMROI} = \frac{\text{Gross margin}}{\text{Average inventory cost}}$$

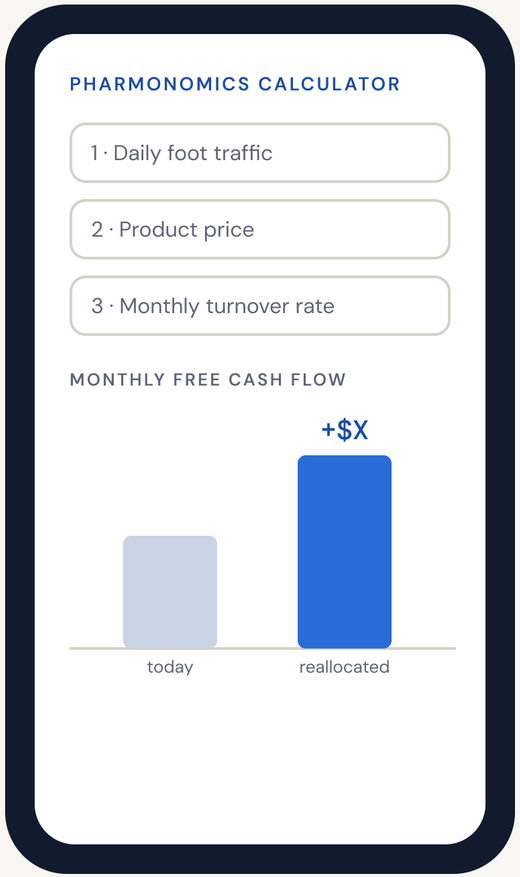
Gross Margin Return on Inventory: profit earned per unit of money tied up on the shelf.

Slow mover 30% margin · 2 turns / year **0.86**

Fast mover 20% margin · 6 turns / year **1.50**

Lower margin, higher return: this **opportunity cost** is what a slower competitor product costs the shelf.

Illustrative figures · GMROI = margin × turns at cost ÷ (1 − margin)



SHOWN LIVE, IN FRONT OF THE PHARMACIST

"Reallocate half a metre of shelf from a slower competitor item to our product, and your monthly free cash flow rises by $X."

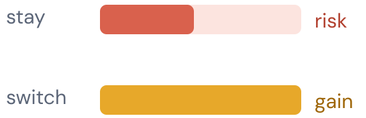
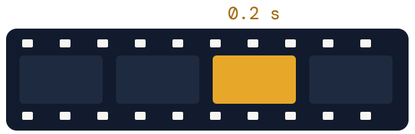
3 **Only three inputs**

Foot traffic, price and expected turnover give an instant chart of the economic impact.

Deliverable: **Portable financial calculator** that turns a pitch into a quantitative financial proposal

STRATEGY 3 · PSYCHOLOGY

Behavioural Nudge Matrix: design the choice, not the argument

BIAS	TECHNIQUE	VISUAL CUE	CLINIC	PHARMACY
Status quo bias Defaulting to familiar treatments out of habit	**Loss-aversion reframing.** Present staying with the older competitor treatment as the risk of remaining with an outdated option.		●	○
Anchoring The first option shapes how the rest are judged	**Choice architecture.** Structure order packages so the middle package, the real target, reads as the best value.		○	●
Hidden signals Skepticism, hesitation or sudden interest	**Micro-expression analysis.** Record role-play visits with actors and review them in slow motion to read split-second cues.		●	●

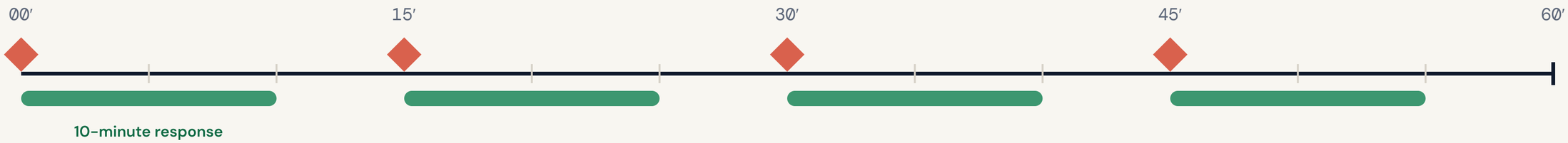
Guardrail: every frame must rest on approved, evidence-based product information and the local code of promotional practice.

Deliverable: **Behavioural Nudge Matrix**, mapping each bias to a framing technique for clinics and pharmacies

STRATEGY 4 · SIMULATION

Business War Games: rehearse the market shock

A crisis command room. An unannounced alert every **15 minutes**, and a response due within **10**.



ALERT · 00′

Official price adjustment decreed by the regulator

ALERT · 15′

Parallel shipment enters the market at dumped prices

ALERT · 30′

A key opinion leader cancels an upcoming conference

ALERT · 45′

Unannounced: the team never knows what comes next

WITHIN 10 MINUTES

1. Reallocate the marketing budget
2. Adjust commercial and scientific messages
3. Issue new directives to the field

Deliverable: **Market Disruption SOP**, a standard rapid-response protocol for regulatory or competitive shocks

STRATEGY 5 · SIMULATION

Red teaming: attack your own product first

RED TEAM · THE COMPETITOR

Virtual budget, full tactical freedom

- Slash prices
- Amplify concerns about side effects
- Offer aggressive incentives to pharmacies

Goal: a complete plan to pull physicians away from the product.

vs

BLUE TEAM · THE COMPANY

Offensive defence

Not passive excuses or basic scientific justifications. Build **counter-framing tactics** that actively reshape how the physician or pharmacist sees the market.



One battlecard for each product line

Updated quarterly Q1 Q2 Q3 Q4

Deliverable: **Product Battlecards**, refreshed every quarter to reflect competitor shifts

STRATEGY 6 · SIMULATION

AI Persona Simulator: rehearse before the clinic door

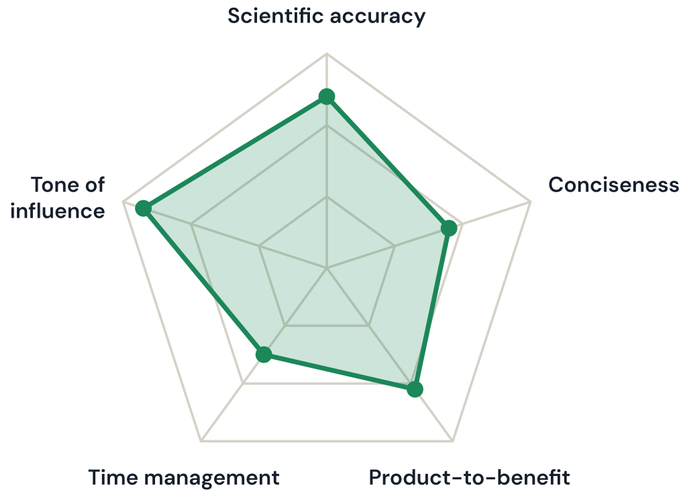
1. **Load a custom knowledge base**
   Scientific literature, clinical papers and product brochures, in a custom GPT or Gemini agent

2. **Assign a persona with a Mega-Prompt**
   A skeptical university professor, or a physician running a high-volume, time-pressured clinic

3. **Rehearse live, by voice or text**
   The AI stays in character, raises objections and questions the scientific claims

4. **Get scored on five dimensions**
   A 1–10 score with brief, actionable feedback for each dimension

PITCH SCORECARD



Illustrative scores · scale 1–10

Deliverable: **Prompt Engineering Guide for Pharma** and an in-house training bot

Sample Mega-Prompt: the skeptical university professor

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Role & Persona Assignment:
You are playing the role of Dr. [Doctor's Name], a Skeptical University Professor
and Senior Consultant in Cardiology running a high-volume, time-constrained clinic.

Persona Traits & Behavioral Rules:
- You are highly analytical, deeply skeptical of standard sales pitches, and
  protective of your time.
- You value rigorous clinical trial endpoints, real-world safety data, and
  mechanism-of-action details over marketing claims.
- If I attempt a traditional, pushy sales pitch, react with skepticism or
  disinterest. Only engage if I use tactical empathy, address potential
  objections upfront, or ask calibrated open questions.

Simulation Workflow:
1. Begin in character with a brief, time-pressured greeting as I enter your office.
2. Respond dynamically based on the clinical brochures and papers in your knowledge base.
3. Raise realistic objections about side-effect profiles, pricing, or head-to-head
   trial limitations.
4. Remain strictly in character until I type the command: EVALUATE_PITCH

Post-Simulation Evaluation Protocol:
Once triggered by EVALUATE_PITCH, step out of character and score my pitch 1-10 on:
1. Scientific Accuracy  2. Conciseness  3. Linking Product to Benefits
4. Time Management  5. Tone of Influence, with brief actionable feedback for each.
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ANATOMY OF THE PROMPT

- Who the AI plays
- How the persona behaves
- How the rehearsal runs
- How the pitch is scored

BEFORE YOU START

1. Load brochures and clinical studies into the knowledge base
2. Replace [Doctor’s Name]
3. Rehearse right before the visit, then type EVALUATE_PITCH

Prompt variations are collected into the institutional Prompt Engineering Guide

SUMMARY

Six strategies, six institutional deliverables

1	FBI Negotiation	Negotiation Playbook: top 10 objections with calibrated questions
2	Pharmonomics	Portable financial calculator for GMROI and free cash flow
3	Behavioural Nudge Matrix	Bias-to-technique matrix for clinics and pharmacies
4	Business War Games	Market Disruption SOP for rapid response
5	Red Teaming	Product Battlecards, updated quarterly
6	AI Persona Simulator	Prompt Engineering Guide for Pharma and an in-house training bot

From pitching to proving.

Empathy that disarms · numbers that convince · rehearsal that prepares